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A Cold War-era Seychelles Mission

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VAPPALA BALACHANDRAN

IN APRIL 1986, Seychelles President France-Albert Rene made a special request to Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi during his visit to New Delhi: Depute a small team of Indian security officials to discreetly assess the existing security and police systems in his country.

This arose because of his doubts about his own security setup and since the entire Indian Ocean Islands were caught in the whirlpool of Cold War polemics. Consequently, this writer was chosen to lead a two-member team in 1987. The other member was a senior Intelligence Bureau (IB) official.

Rene, a "leftist," had ousted James Mancham, the first "right-wing" president, from power in 1977, one year after the country's independence. Since then, Mancham was openly in cohorts with the Western and South African intelligence agencies to return to power through counter-coup or elections.

Although Rene personally knew many foreign leaders like French President Francois Mitterrand or Tanzanian President Julius Nyerere, there were reasons why he turned to India to do this sensitive work. He did not want to be caught in the Cold War crossfire. Also, France, which had guided Seychelles' security for long, had turned against it for geopolitical reasons, forcing Rene to

temporarily turn to Tanzania and the Soviet Union to save his government.

Further, the May 13, 1978, coup in the Comoros orchestrated by a French mercenary named Bob Denard had successfully overthrown the leftist President Ali Soilih and had brought back former president Ahmed Abdallah, who was ousted in 1975. Ahmed Abdallah had then promptly restored his close ties with France and other Western countries.

Meanwhile, Mancham, on May 24, 1983, told *The Observer* in London that he had accepted GBP 12,000 from MI-6 for his campaign. He admitted he had signed two agreements with the CIA, well before the Seychelles got independence in 1976, through which the agency would set up an intelligence system to monitor his opponents and create a para-military unit in the Seychelles. The other agreement was to subsidise his weekly *Seychelles News* through the US embassy in Nairobi.

More light was thrown on Rene's predicament by a CIA assessment document ("The Mellowing of President Rene", October 1983), declassified only in 2008: In April 1979, he had to hurriedly request the Soviet Union to send warships to show support during a suspected coup in the Seychelles. In November that year, the Soviet Union was again asked to send warships against a suspected French plot to oust him. During that period, Rene even arrested a French police adviser then working with him and deported him to France. *The New York Times* (December 23, 1979) identified him as Jacques Chevalereau.

The CIA paper also said that Rene detained a French military crew working in a Seychellois patrol boat "Topaz". The paper

We were first taken to the President's secretary, who led us to Rene's modest office, where he gave us a briefing on what he was looking for. He frankly told us he could not trust his own security set-up due to "colour" divisions.

said Rene's suspicions against the French involvement "were not totally groundless according to US Embassy reporting".

These destabilising efforts reached a nadir on November 25, 1981, when 43 South Africa-supported mercenaries called "The Froth Blowers" led by British-Irish Colonel Thomas "Mad" Mike Hoare arrived at Mahe, Seychelles International Airport through Air Swaziland F-28 (Fokker) chartered aircraft. Their original idea was to enter the country like tourists and incite Rene's opponents to rise in revolt. This time India was unwittingly involved in this attempted coup.

Although Hoare's boys were dressed as tourists, a chance examination by a local customs official led to the discovery of AK-47 rifles in their baggage. Knowing that their game was up, the mercenaries took 70 airport staff hostage. They also took control of the airport control tower.

At that time a Boeing 707 Air India flight 224 led by Captain Umesh Saxena from Salisbury (now Harare), which was going to Bombay with 64 passengers on board, was arriving at the Mahe airport for a scheduled refuelling. While Hoare's mercenaries allowed it to land, the local security forces assisted by Tanzanian soldiers did not want it to come down. A fire fight ensued which damaged the mercenary plane F-28 (Fokker).

Hoare's mercenaries realised they could escape only through the AI flight and tried to force Captain Saxena to take them to Zimbabwe. They finally agreed to travel to Durban due to fuel shortage. At Durban, the mercenaries were arrested and later prosecuted.

In this background, we landed early in 1987 at the Mahe international airport near

their capital city Victoria. We expected the airport and capital city to be ringed by uniformed troops in view of the earlier coup attempts. Surprisingly, we did not notice any unusual police or armed forces deployment there or on our way to the hotel.

The next morning, when we were taken to the presidential palace to meet President Rene, we were again surprised to find that except for a ceremonial guard outside, the corridors of the palace were deserted. We were first taken to the President's secretary, who led us to Rene's modest office, where he gave us a briefing on what he was looking for.

He frankly told us he could not trust his own security set-up due to "colour" divisions. He said he was changing the white Commissioner of Police and appointing a "mulatto" officer who had better relations with people, especially blacks. He wanted us to visit all the security establishments, including training institutes, assess their professionalism and give suggestions. In addition, he openly told us that he would have to work with the Western nations to dispel the notion that he was merely following the Soviet bloc. Amazingly, the same assessment was made by the CIA document in 1983 saying that Rene was "showing a more positive attitude toward the major US interest in Seychelles—the USAF tracking station in Mahe".

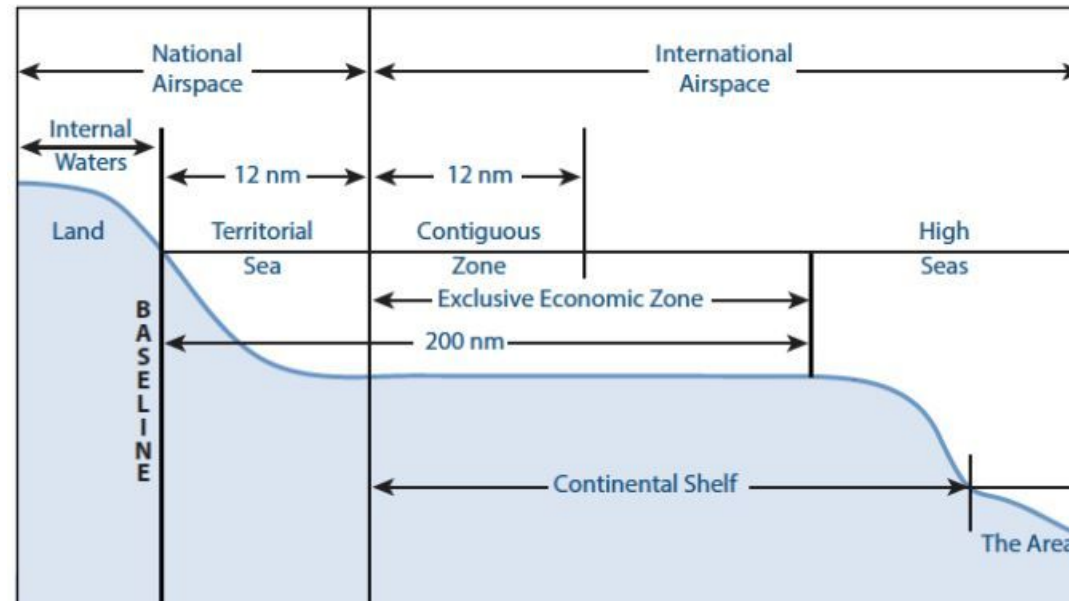
We completed our assignment within a week and orally presented our findings to him, adding that we would send our written report through our Prime Minister's office.

The writer is a former Special Secretary, Cabinet Secretariat, and was part of the committee to enquire into the 26/11 terror attacks

A Cold War-era Seychelles Mission

United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS) 1982, also known as Law of the Sea divides marine areas into five main zones namely- Internal Waters, Territorial Sea, Contiguous Zone, Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ) and the High Seas.

UNCLOS is the only international convention which stipulates a framework for state jurisdiction in maritime spaces. It provides a different legal status to different maritime zones.



A Cold War-era Seychelles Mission

Territorial Sea: The territorial sea extends seaward up to 12 nautical miles (nm) from its baselines. The coastal states have sovereignty and jurisdiction over the territorial sea. These rights extend not only on the surface but also to the seabed, subsoil, and even airspace. The innocent passage refers to the passing through the waters which are not prejudicial to peace and security. However, the nations have the right to suspend the same.

Contiguous Zone : The contiguous zone extends seaward up to 24 nm from its baselines. It is an intermediary zone between the territorial sea and the high seas. Unlike the territorial sea, the contiguous zone only gives jurisdiction to a state on the ocean's surface and floor. It does not provide air and space rights. But the coastal states rights are limited by the innocent passage through the territorial sea.

EEZ : Each coastal State may claim an EEZ beyond and adjacent to its territorial sea that extends seaward up to 200 nm from its baselines. Sovereign rights for the purpose of exploring, exploiting, conserving and managing natural resources, whether living or nonliving, of the seabed and subsoil. Rights to carry out activities like the production of energy from the water, currents and wind.

High Seas:

The ocean surface and the water column beyond the EEZ are referred to as the high seas. It is considered as “the common heritage of all mankind” and is beyond any national jurisdiction.

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A Cold War-era Seychelles Mission

Regarding the United Nations Convention on the Law of Sea, consider the following statements:

1. A coastal state has the right to establish the breadth of its territorial sea up to a limit not exceeding 12 nautical miles, measured from a baseline determined following the convention.
2. Ships of all states, whether coastal or land-locked, enjoy the right of innocent passage through the territorial sea.
3. The Exclusive Economic Zone shall not extend beyond 200 nautical miles from the baseline from which the breadth of the territorial sea is measured.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

This question was previously asked in
UPSC Civil Services Exam Official
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1. 1 and 2 only

2. 2 and 3 only

3. 1 and 3 only

4. 1, 2 and 3

India-Israel Bilateral Investment Agreement Comes Into Effect

India-Israel bilateral investment agreement comes into effect

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, July 4

THE INDIA-Israel Bilateral Investment Agreement (BIA), which will ensure a secure and predictable investment climate between the two countries, came into force from Saturday, the finance ministry said.

The pact, which will provide protection to the two-way investments, is expected to contribute to increased cross-border investment activity.

The two countries inked the treaty on September 8 last year.

Under the pact, India has cut down the local remedies exhaustion period for Israeli investors to three years.

Local remedies exhaustion means that investors must first try to resolve their disputes using the legal system of the host country before they can take the matter to international arbitration. Normally, India keeps a five-year period for this.

The India-Israel BIA also includes portfolio investments in a deviation from such treaties in the past.

Israel is the first OECD (Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development) member with which India has inked this agreement.

The agreement is expected to pave the way for increased bilateral investments between the two countries. During April 2000 and March 2026, India received \$371.35 million foreign direct investment (FDI) from Israel.

The implementation of the pact is important as both countries are also negotiating a free trade pact. The negotiations for the trade pact are going slow due to the West Asia crisis. India is also negotiating bilateral investment treaties with other countries, including Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Oman, Switzerland, Russia, Australia and the European Union.

These investment treaties help in protecting and promoting investments in each other's countries. The government has earlier announced revamping the current model of BITs to make it more investor-friendly and attract foreign players.

Commenting on the pact, think tank GTRI said the 2015 model text treaty has excluded portfolio investments, while the Israel agreement covers shares, stocks and other equity holdings, as well as qualifying bonds, loans and other corporate debt.

"This could widen India's exposure to investor-state disputes beyond traditional foreign direct investment to certain financial investments," GTRI Founder Ajay Srivastava said. He said the Israel pact allows investors to seek international arbitration after pursuing domestic legal remedies.

India-Israel Bilateral Investment Agreement Comes Into Effect

- **The Agreement**

- The India-Israel Bilateral Investment Agreement (BIA), signed on September 8 last year, came into force from Saturday, providing a secure and predictable investment climate between the two countries

- **Israel's Distinct Status**

- Israel is the first **OECD member** country with which India has signed such an investment agreement

- **Wider Context**

- India is also negotiating similar investment treaties with Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Oman, Switzerland, Russia, Australia and the EU; a separate India-Israel free trade pact is progressing slowly due to the West Asia crisis

India-Israel Bilateral Investment Agreement Comes Into Effect

- **Bilateral Investment Treaties (BITs)**

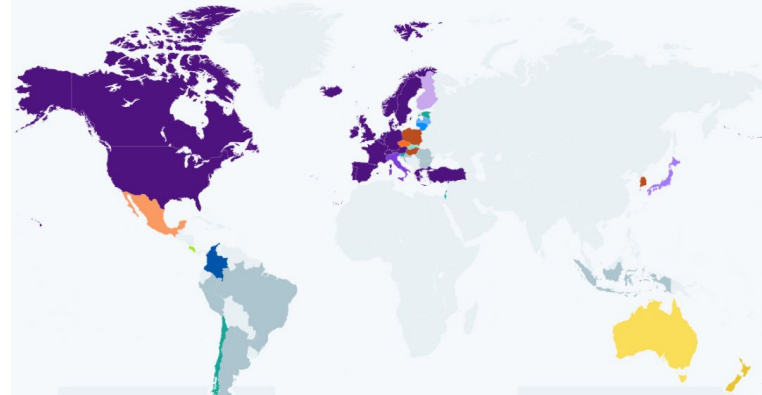
- Also referred to as International Investment Agreements (IIAs), they are a tool for providing assurance to foreign investors against measures that may adversely impact their investments while assuring state's sovereign right to regulate

- **OECD**

- The OECD was established on Dec. 14, 1960, by 18 European nations, plus the United States and Canada. (Present : 38 Countries)
- OECD members are typically democratic countries that support free-market economies.
- India has been an OECD Key Partner since 2007.
- Headquarters: Paris, France.

Which Countries Are in the OECD?

Members of the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, by year joined (as of June 2024)



- 1961**
 - Austria
 - Belgium
 - Canada
 - Denmark
 - France
 - Germany
 - Greece
 - Iceland
 - Ireland
 - Luxembourg
 - Netherlands
 - Norway
 - Portugal
 - Spain
 - Sweden
 - Switzerland
 - Turkey
 - United Kingdom
 - United States
- 1962**
 - Italy

- 1964**
 - Japan
- 1969**
 - Finland
- 1971**
 - Australia
- 1973**
 - New Zealand
- 1994**
 - Mexico
- 1995**
 - Czechia
- 1996**
 - Hungary
 - South Korea
 - Poland
- 2000**
 - Slovak Republic

- 2010**
 - Chile
 - Estonia
 - Israel
 - Slovenia
- 2016**
 - Latvia
- 2018**
 - Lithuania
- 2020**
 - Colombia
- 2021**
 - Costa Rica

Countries in OECD accession talks:

- Argentina
- Brazil
- Bulgaria
- Croatia
- Indonesia
- Peru
- Romania

Source: OECD



India-Israel Bilateral Investment Agreement Comes Into Effect



India-Israel Bilateral Investment Agreement Comes Into Effect



The Levant is a historical and geographical term referring to the region along the eastern Mediterranean shores. It encompasses modern-day Israel, Jordan, Lebanon, Syria, Palestine, and parts of Turkey

India-Israel Bilateral Investment Agreement Comes Into Effect



Mashriq, geographic region extending from the western border of Egypt to the eastern border of Iraq. It includes the modern states of Egypt, Sudan, Saudi Arabia, Yemen, Oman, Kuwait, the United Arab Emirates, Israel, Jordan, Lebanon, Syria, and Iraq and covers an area of approximately 2.7 million square miles (7 million square km).

The Mashriq comprises two major physical regions.

One consists of barren desert areas that are dominated by the great plateau of the Arabian Peninsula and that support the nomadic Bedouin people. Average summer temperatures in this region exceed 120 °F (48.9 °C).

The other region consists of the rich and fertile territory that is generally defined by the **Fertile Crescent**. Long considered to have been the “cradle of civilization,” the Fertile Crescent extends in an arc from the Nile River valley through Israel, Lebanon, Jordan, and Syria and into Iraq. At either tip of the crescent is a river valley—that of the Tigris and Euphrates in the east and that of the Nile in the west—that is annually flooded and replenished with alluvium.

GULF COOPERATION COUNCIL



India-Israel Bilateral Investment Agreement Comes Into Effect

The (GCC) is a regional intergovernmental organisation formed to promote political coordination, economic integration, and security cooperation among Arab states of the Persian Gulf.

Established: 1981

Headquarters: Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

Nature: Political, economic, and security bloc

Peninsula Shield Force: Joint military force of GCC members

Member Countries : The GCC comprises six Gulf monarchies:

Members : Saudi Arabia, United Arab Emirates, Qatar, Kuwait, Oman and Bahrain

India-Israel Bilateral Investment Agreement Comes Into Effect



Israel is a resilient democracy located at the eastern end of the Mediterranean Sea in West Asia (the Levant).

Jerusalem is the seat of the Israeli government, including the Knesset (Parliament) and the Supreme Court.

Bordering Nations: Lebanon, Syria, Jordan, West Bank, Egypt, Gaza Strip, and Mediterranean Sea.

The Dead Sea: Located in the Jordan Rift Valley, it is the lowest point on Earth's surface (approx. 430m below sea level) and is famous for its extreme salinity.

Sea of Galilee (Lake Tiberias): Israel's largest freshwater lake and a primary water source.

India-Israel Bilateral Investment Agreement Comes Into Effect



Tel Aviv : Economic and technological hub of Israel; frequent location for diplomatic and tech-related summits.

Hebron : Religious site housing the Tomb of the Patriarchs; a flashpoint for Israeli-Palestinian tensions.

Nablus : Economic hub of the West Bank and a key center of Palestinian resistance

Ramallah : Administrative center of the Palestinian Authority.

Ashkelon : Frequently in the news due to its proximity to Gaza and vulnerability to cross-border attacks.

India-Israel Bilateral Investment Agreement Comes Into Effect



The Golan Heights is a 1,200-square-kilometre rocky plateau in southwestern Syria, overlooking the Jordan River Valley.

Israel captured most of the Golan Heights from Syria in the 1967 Six-Day War. Syria's attempt to retake it during the 1973 war failed.

The area remains divided by a United Nations-monitored demilitarized zone (DMZ), with Israeli and Syrian forces separated by the "Area of Separation," a buffer zone created under the 1974 Agreement.

Druze People stay here.

India-Israel Bilateral Investment Agreement Comes Into Effect

Q2. Which one of the following countries of South-West Asia does not open out to the Mediterranean Sea? (2015)

- (a) Syria**
- (b) Jordan**
- (c) Lebanon**
- (d) Israel**

Q3. The area known as 'Golan Heights' sometimes appears in the news in the context of the events related to (2015)

- (a) Central Asia**
- (b) Middle East**
- (c) South-East Asia**
- (d) Central Africa**

Assam Releases Booklet Showcasing Bodoland Forests' Butterfly Diversity

Assam releases booklet showcasing Bodoland forests' butterfly diversity

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

The Assam Forest Department on Saturday released a special booklet on the butterflies found in the forest landscape of the Bodoland Territorial Region (BTR).

Hagrama Mohilary, the Chief Executive Member of Bodoland Territorial Council (BTC), released the booklet in Kokrajhar, about 220 kilometres west of Guwahati.

Spread across 3,653 sq. km., the Bodoland forest landscape comprises a mosaic of tropical evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist mixed-deciduous forests, and alluvial grasslands situated at the confluence of the Indo-Malayan and In-



Lime butterfly found in BTR of Northeast India.

SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

do-Gangetic biogeographic zones. The landscape supports 346 of Assam's 620 recorded butterfly species, including several rare, endemic and threatened taxa, making BTR one of the richest butterfly habitats in Northeast India.

According to Sonali Ghosh, the chief of the Forest Department for BTR, the region is the only ecological corridor in the

Northeast where butterfly species of the Eastern Himalayas, Indo-Malayan region, and the Indo-Gangetic plains occur together.

BTR's Ultapani-Manas landscape supports several rare and remarkable butterflies including the endemic yellow-crested spangle (*Papilio elephenor*) and Swinhoe's flat (*Celaenorrhinus zea*). Other notable Eastern Himalayan species recorded from the landscape include the great windmill (*Byasa dasarada*), Moore's cupid (*Shijimia moorei*), Mussoorie bush bob (*Pedesta masuriensis*), and green awlet (*Burara vasutana*).

Among the Ultapani-Manas landscape's Indo-Malayan butterflies is the witch (*Araotes lapithis*).

This landscape also boasts the Indian cupid (*Everes lacturnus assamica*) and the white-line bushbrown (*Mycalesis malsara*), rarely found elsewhere in the Northeast.

Experts from the Northeast Butterfly Meet Network say the BTR represents not only an extraordinary centre of butterfly diversity but also a unique cultural landscape where butterflies have inspired traditional folklore and performing arts. The Bagurumba, popularly known as the butterfly dance of the Bodo community, is believed to have been inspired by the colourful mud-puddling congregations witnessed across the forests during the monsoon.

Assam Releases Booklet Showcasing Bodoland Forests' Butterfly Diversity

- **The Booklet**

- The Assam Forest Department released a special booklet on butterflies of the Bodoland Territorial Region (BTR) forest landscape, unveiled by BTC Chief Hagrama Mohilary in Kokrajhar

- **BTR's Ecological Significance**

- Spread across 3,653 sq km, BTR sits at the confluence of the Indo-Malayan and Indo-Gangetic biogeographic zones — the only ecological corridor in the Northeast where Eastern Himalayan, Indo-Malayan and Indo-Gangetic species occur together

- **Rich Butterfly Diversity**

- BTR supports 346 of Assam's 620 recorded butterfly species, including rare, endemic and threatened taxa such as the yellow-crested spangle and Swinhoe's flat

- **Notable and Rare Species**

- **Includes the great windmill, Moore's cupid, Mussoorie bush bob, green awlet, Indian cupid and the white-line bushbrown, rarely found elsewhere in the Northeast**

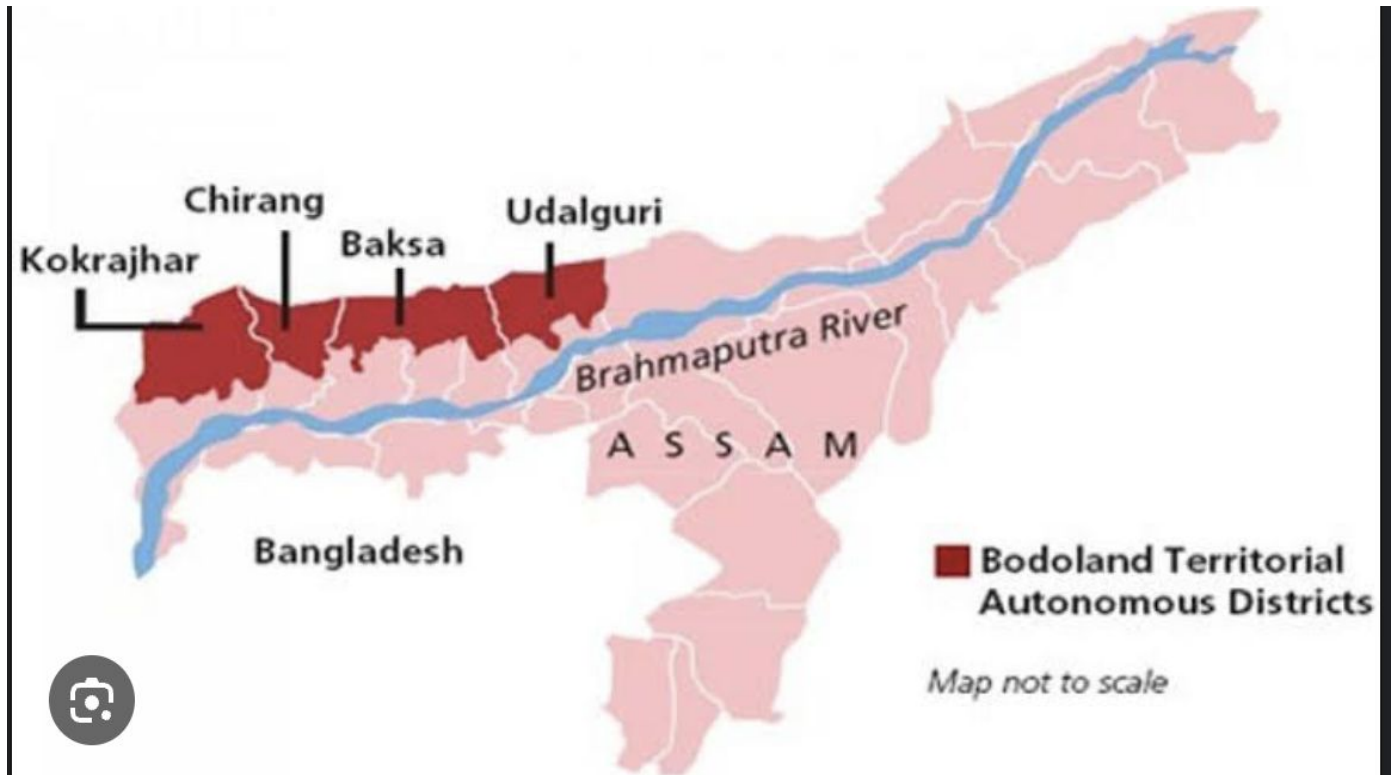
- **Cultural Connection**

- Butterflies have inspired traditional Bodo folklore and performing arts, including the Bagurumba (butterfly dance), believed to be inspired by mud-puddling congregations during the monsoon

Assam Releases Booklet Showcasing Bodoland Forests' Butterfly Diversity

- **Bodos**

- Bagurumba Dwhou was a historic mass cultural event showcasing the traditional Bagurumba dance of the Bodo community. The word Dwhou means “wave” in Bodo.
- Bagurumba is also known as the “Butterfly Dance” for its graceful, flowing movements that mimic butterflies, birds, and swaying trees



PM's Indonesia Visit Could Lay Foundations of Nickel Diplomacy

PM's Indonesia visit could lay foundations of nickel diplomacy



Ajai Malhotra

INDONESIA'S TRANSITION to electric mobility and clean energy requires secure access to critical minerals, especially nickel. The world's largest nickel reserves lie in Indonesia, where Chinese investment has established a dominant position in downstream processing. The future of clean energy will depend as much on nickel-processing plants as on EV factories. India may have only a few years to establish a meaningful presence in Indonesia's nickel value chain. Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Indonesia from July 6 to 8 could offer India its best opportunity to secure a place in the critical mineral value chain that will shape its energy transition and supply-chain resilience.

The visit means that President Prabowo Subianto's 2025 visit to India, Rogers a six-day Indo-Pacific tour that will also take PM Modi to New Zealand and Australia. Indonesia is among India's oldest partners in Asia. Indian cultural links with Java, Bali and Sumatra stretch back centuries, while the 1953 Bandung Conference helped lay the foundations of the Non-Aligned Movement. Today, that shared legacy finds expression in a strategic partnership spanning the Indian Ocean and the wider Indo-Pacific. The world's largest archipelagic state, Indonesia straddles the Malacca Strait, one of the world's busiest maritime arteries, whose western approach India guards. As Asia's two largest democracies, their shared boundary in the Andaman Sea makes cooperation on maritime security and connectivity imperative. India's Act East Policy, too, aligns closely with Indonesia's maritime ambitions — Subsequent to the 2016 Comprehensive Strategic Partnership, the PM's visit aims to translate strategic convergence into practical cooperation on critical minerals, connectivity, healthcare, space, digital public infrastructure and tourism.

Indonesia also possesses cobalt, bauxite, tin and rare earths. India requires a sustained commercial presence across Indonesia's critical mineral value chains through joint ventures, upstream equity and mineral processing partnerships. The strategy's success will depend on Indian industry's ability to match the speed of the Chinese counterparts to establishing a meaningful presence in Indonesia's nickel value chain.

If PM Modi's Jakarta visit propels that conversation, President Prabowo's expected visit to India for the BRICS Summit in September could provide an early opportunity to advance it.

Indonesia is India's second largest ASEAN trading partner, but economic ties remain below potential. India runs a trade deficit of about US\$20 billion. The two governments aim to expand bilateral trade to US\$100 billion by 2030.

If critical minerals represent the visit's longer-term strategic opportunity, defence cooperation might provide its most tangible immediate outcome. Substantial progress in Jakarta towards acquiring BrahMos supersonic cruise missiles would strengthen Indonesia's deterrence capability, building on the BrahMos export to the Philippines. It would burnish India's credentials as a reliable security partner for countries seeking stronger defence capabilities without becoming entangled in great-power rivalries.

China's growing maritime assertiveness forms the strategic backdrop. Beijing's "Nine Dash Line" overlaps Indonesia's Exclusive Economic Zone around the Natuna Islands. While India works through arrangements such as the Quad, Indonesia maintains close economic ties with China even as it expands maritime cooperation with India and others.

As Southeast Asia's largest economy and a leading ASEAN voice, Indonesia has a central place in India's Indo-Pacific strategy. The two countries share an interest in preserving freedom of navigation, maintaining regional stability and strengthening ASEAN centrality. Indonesia's BRICS and Indian Ocean Rim Association memberships broaden the platform through which both countries can advance shared interests.

Thanks in part to alphabetic seating at the UN General Assembly, Indian and Indonesian diplomats have for decades worked alongside one another, developing camaraderie and trust that underpin the bilateral partnership.

Connectivity is of growing importance. Limited direct flights, lacking shipping links and restricted visa periods constrain ties. Initiatives linking the Andaman and Nicobar Islands with Indonesia's Aceh Province deserve greater momentum.

PM Modi's visit signals India's intent to deepen engagement with one of its most consequential maritime neighbours. The two countries do not merely share an ocean; they share responsibility for preserving its stability and openness, while deepening cooperation on critical minerals and supply-chain resilience.

The writer is distinguished fellow, TERI and a former senior diplomat.

PM's Indonesia Visit Could Lay Foundations of Nickel Diplomacy

- **Strategic Context**

- India's transition to electric mobility and clean energy requires secure access to critical minerals, especially nickel; **Indonesia holds the world's largest nickel reserves**

- **The Visit**

- PM Modi's visit to Indonesia (July 6-8) reciprocates President Prabowo Subianto's 2025 visit to India; part of a six-day Indo-Pacific tour also covering New Zealand and Australia

- **Building on Existing Ties**

- The visit builds on the 2018 Comprehensive Strategic Partnership, aiming to translate convergence into cooperation on critical minerals, connectivity, healthcare, space, digital infrastructure and tourism

- **Economic Stakes**

- Indonesia is India's second-largest ASEAN trading partner; bilateral trade runs a deficit of about \$20 billion, with both governments aiming to expand trade to \$100 billion by 2030

- **Strategic Backdrop**

- China's "Nine-Dash Line" overlaps Indonesia's Exclusive Economic Zone; as Asia's two largest democracies, India and Indonesia share an interest in freedom of navigation and regional stability

PM's Indonesia Visit Could Lay Foundations of Nickel Diplomacy

- Indonesia is an archipelagic nation located off the coast of mainland Southeast Asia, situated between the Indian and Pacific Oceans.
- Positioned across the Equator, it lies in both the Northern and Southern Hemispheres.
- Land Borders: Shares borders with Malaysia, Papua New Guinea, and Timor-Leste.
- Consists of over 17,504 islands, including five main islands: Sumatra, Java, Kalimantan (Borneo), Sulawesi, and Papua.
- Part of the “Ring of Fire,” Indonesia experiences frequent earthquakes and volcanic eruptions.
- Houses over 100 active volcanoes, including Mount Merapi and Mount Krakatoa.
- National Capital: Jakarta (new capital is being relocated to Nusantara).
- Wallace Line: This deep-sea boundary separates Asian wildlife in western Indonesia from Australian-type species in the east, creating one of the world’s richest biodiversity zones.



Thank You